

# Rising Intonation in American English

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This document includes common examples of rising intonation as used in everyday American English conversation. Each sentence includes a note about the pitch pattern and a Spanish translation to aid comprehension for Spanish-speaking learners.

Rising intonation means your voice goes up at the end of a sentence. In American English, we often use rising intonation for **yes/no questions**, to show **uncertainty**, or when we want the listener to know we're **not finished speaking yet**. It helps people understand whether you're asking, checking, or continuing your ideas.

La entonación ascendente significa que tu voz sube al final de la frase. En inglés americano, se usa mucho en **preguntas de sí o no**, para mostrar **duda o incertidumbre**, o para indicar que **todavía no has terminado de hablar**. Ayuda a que las personas entiendan si estás preguntando, confirmando algo o continuando tus ideas.

| English Example                       | Pitch Note                | Spanish Translation   |
|---------------------------------------|---------------------------|-----------------------|
| Are you ready?                        | Rising pitch on 'ready'   | ¿Estás listo?         |
| Do you like it?                       | Rising pitch on 'it'      | ¿Te gusta?            |
| Is she coming?                        | Rising pitch on 'coming'  | ¿Ella viene?          |
| Did you call him?                     | Rising pitch on 'him'     | ¿Lo llamaste?         |
| Have you eaten yet?                   | Rising pitch on 'yet'     | ¿Ya comiste?          |
| Are we meeting today?                 | Rising pitch on 'today'   | ¿Nos reunimos hoy?    |
| Can I help you?                       | Rising pitch on 'you'     | ¿Puedo ayudarte?      |
| Is this your phone?                   | Rising pitch on 'phone'   | ¿Este es tu teléfono? |
| Are you serious?                      | Rising pitch on 'serious' | ¿Hablas en serio?     |
| Do you want coffee?                   | Rising pitch on 'coffee'  | ¿Quieres café?        |
| I got apples,<br>bananas,<br>oranges, | Rising pitch on 'apples'  | Compré manzanas,      |
|                                       | Rising pitch on 'bananas' | plátanos,             |
|                                       | Rising pitch on 'oranges' | naranjas,             |

|                                    |                           |                                     |
|------------------------------------|---------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| and grapes.                        | Falling pitch on 'grapes' | y uvas.                             |
| Maybe we could try something else? | Rising pitch on 'else'    | ¿Quizás podríamos probar otra cosa? |
| I think it's okay...?              | Rising pitch on 'okay'    | ¿Creo que está bien?                |
| You're going to the party...?      | Rising pitch on 'party'   | ¿Vas a la fiesta?                   |
| So... you're not mad?              | Rising pitch on 'mad'     | ¿Entonces... no estás enojado?      |
| This is the right address...?      | Rising pitch on 'address' | ¿Esta es la dirección correcta?     |
| I'm supposed to be here...?        | Rising pitch on 'here'    | ¿Se supone que debo estar aquí?     |